



Fast and furious: The derby between Real Madrid and Atletico Madrid was the highlight of Spanish top-flight football on matchday 23. AFP

disappointing outing, losing 1-2 against Fulham.

After matchday 24, Liverpool led the standings with 56 points and a game in hand, with Arsenal, Nottingham Forest, and Chelsea occupying second, third, and fourth with 50, 47, and 43 points, respectively. City is fifth with 41 points while United languishes in 13th with 29 points.

La Liga

With Real Madrid playing against Atletico Madrid at the Santiago Bernabeu, Carlo Ancelotti's men would have hoped for a win against their arch-rival to extend their lead at the top of the standings but were held to a frustrating 1-1 draw by Diego Simeone's men.

Julian Alvarez drew first blood, putting his team ahead from the spot

in the 35th minute. Atletico got the penalty after Aurelien Tchouameni brought down Samuel Lino inside the area. A VAR check confirmed the decision.

Real responded well after half-time as Kylian Mbappe scored the equaliser on the rebound following a well-constructed attack by the defending champion in the 50th minute.

It was another dominant day at the office for Hansi Flick's Barcelona, which secured a 4-1 away victory against Sevilla. Robert Lewandowski opened the scoring in the seventh minute, but Sevilla levelled a minute

later courtesy of Ruben Vargas. However, second-half goals from Fermin Lopez, Raphinha, and Eric Garcia sealed the win for the Catalans. It was not a perfect outing for Barca, though, as it finished the match with 10 men after Fermin was shown a red card in the 62nd minute.

Athletic Bilbao cruised to a 3-0 win against Girona, while Villarreal edged past Las Palmas 2-1.

After matchday 23, Real Madrid continued to top the table with 50 points. Atletico is second with 49, and Barcelona occupies third with 48. Athletic sits in the final Champions League spot in fourth with 44 points.



Bayer Leverkusen played for half an hour with 10 men but managed to hold onto its lead and beat relegation-threatened Hoffenheim 3-1.